

PEOPLE OF FAITH

Bible Character Study Workbook

Characters

Study pages for six people whose faith (and failures) still teach us something: Esther, Ruth, David, Paul, Mary, and Joseph. Each page follows the same simple pattern -- read the passage, then work through who they were, what they faced, and what it means for you.

Esther -- Called for such a time as this

Esther 4:14-16

For years Esther kept her Jewish identity hidden in the Persian court -- until the moment came when staying silent would cost her people everything.

Study Questions

What was Esther's turning point, and what did it cost her to act? _____

What situation in your life might God be positioning you for right now? _____

Ruth -- Loyalty that chooses the harder road

Ruth 1:16

A Moabite widow with every reason to go home instead chose to stay with her mother-in-law Naomi, and with Naomi's God.

Study Questions

What does Ruth's loyalty cost her, and what does it eventually lead to? _____

Who in your life needs that same kind of steady, chosen loyalty from you? _____

David -- A shepherd who became king -- and still failed

1 Samuel 17:45

David's story includes giant-slaying courage and devastating moral failure. Scripture doesn't hide either one.

Study Questions

Why do you think God calls David 'a man after his own heart' despite his failures? _____

What does David's honesty in the Psalms teach you about bringing your own failures to God? _____

Paul -- From persecutor to apostle

Philippians 3:7-8

Paul spent his early life imprisoning Christians -- then became the New Testament's most prolific missionary and writer.

Study Questions

What convinces you that someone's past doesn't disqualify their future with God? _____

What is something Paul 'counted as loss' that you might need to let go of too? _____

Mary -- Willing, even without understanding

Luke 1:38

A teenage girl said yes to an impossible, world-altering calling before she had any of her questions answered.

Study Questions

What does Mary's response teach you about obedience before full understanding? _____

Where is God asking you to say yes before you have every detail worked out? _____

Joseph -- What was meant for evil, God meant for good

Genesis 50:20

Betrayed by his brothers, enslaved, falsely imprisoned -- and still, decades later, able to see God's hand across the whole story.

Study Questions

Is there a painful chapter of your life you're still waiting to see redeemed? _____

What would it look like to trust God with the parts of your story you don't understand yet? _____
